

Configuration Reference

English documentation for the user configuration variables

VARIABLE NAMES AND VALUES PRESERVED

DOCUMENT STRUCTURE

01	Location selection Application name, preferred location, probability and random pool
02	Switching and Secure Core Server rotation timing and Secure Core probability
03	Notifications and terminal output Notification controls and terminal information
04	Failure handling Retry limits and increasing delays

01

Location selection

Define how the script identifies itself and chooses a VPN destination.

APPNAME="\$ (basename "\$0")"

The application name is displayed in notifications. Depending on the operating system, desktop notifications may associate notification logs with an application. By default, the application name matches the file name.

MAIN_LOCATION="US"

Defines a prioritized VPN location. Servers from the random pool are not selected when the probability condition for MAIN_LOCATION is met.

ACCEPTED FORMATS

Countries	Cities	Servers
US, UK	Amsterdam	US#1

PROBABILITY_MAIN_LOCATION=0

Controls the probability that MAIN_LOCATION is used.

0	MAIN_LOCATION is not used. Only servers from the random pool are selected.
50	MAIN_LOCATION is used with a probability of 50%.
100	MAIN_LOCATION is always used. The random pool is no longer used.

ALLOWED VALUES 0 - 100

RANDOM_POOL

Server pool used for random selection. Countries, cities and individual servers are accepted.

ACCEPTED FORMATS

Countries	Cities	Servers
US, UK	Amsterdam	US#1

02

Switching and Secure Core

Control server rotation, timing and Secure Core usage.

SWITCH_VPN_ONOFF="ON"

Controls whether servers are switched. When switching is disabled, the script establishes one random connection and keeps it active.

ALLOWED VALUES ON, OFF

SECONDS_SWITCH_VPN_MAX=10800

Maximum time until the next switch. Must not be smaller than the minimum value.

ALLOWED VALUES integer

SECONDS_SWITCH_VPN_MIN=600

Minimum time until the next switch. Must not be greater than the maximum value.

ALLOWED VALUES integer

PROBABILITY_SECURECORE=0

Controls the probability that a connection uses Secure Core.

NOTE

This setting may cause a connection attempt to fail when the pool contains cities or servers that do not support Secure Core. protonvpn-random selects another server from the pool and reports the failed connection.

0	Off
50	Used with a probability of 50%
100	On

ALLOWED VALUES 0 - 100

03

Notifications and terminal output

Control global notification behavior and information shown in a terminal.

```
NOTIFY_ALLOFF="NO"
NOTIFY_VPN_ERROR_ONOFF="ON"
NOTIFY_VPN_OK_ONOFF="ON"
NOTIFY_EXIT_ONOFF="ON"
NOTIFY_ASK_ONOFF="ON"
```

Setting NOTIFY_ALLOFF to OFF disables all following notifications. Otherwise, each notification remains individually configurable.

ALLOWED VALUES NO, OFF

```
PROTON_INFO_ONOFF="ON"
```

Loads the output from protonvpn at startup when protonvpn-random is running in a terminal.

ALLOWED VALUES ON, OFF

```
START_MESSAGE_ONOFF="ON"
```

Displays a short information message when protonvpn-random is running in a terminal.

ALLOWED VALUES ON, OFF

GLOBAL

NOTIFY_ALLOFF acts as the master switch. The four following variables remain the individual controls.

04

Failure handling

Define how many failures are tolerated and how retry delays grow.

MAX_CON_FAILS=2

Number of consecutive connection failures allowed before the program exits. Exiting protonvpn-random does not automatically terminate an existing connection.

ALLOWED VALUES integer

INCREASING_DELAY=10

Number of seconds the script waits after a failed connection attempt before the next attempt. The delay increases by this same amount after every connection failure.

ALLOWED VALUES Integer

RETRY BEHAVIOR AT A GLANCE



Operational note

A program exit after repeated failures does not by itself disconnect a VPN connection that is already active.